

MAKE WAY FOR EDUCATION!

Even in the times of recession there are some sectors which continue to grow. Education is a prime example of such an evergreen sector. Should the Indian electronics industry seek an opportunity for expansion into this hitherto unexplored market?

■ SUDESHNA DAS WITH INPUTS FROM ABHIJIT PAUL CHOUDHURY

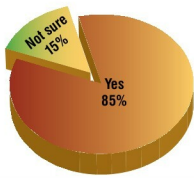
The education sector, as always, plays a prominent role in the shaping of any industry; simply because it provides it with its soul—the employees. Centres for higher studies like colleges and universities are also centres for research and innovation, which can, in the long run, benefit the industry.

To the electronics industry, however, the education sector holds a further promise of possible business ventures. No surprise therefore when 85 per cent respondents to an EFY survey of leading electronics firms of India considered the educational sector as a potential market for present as well as future investment. It is one of the significant business sectors for the Indian electronics industry as it requires newest electronics products and concurrent technologies to develop the future manpower for the nation.

Vision towards investment

When one talks about the education sector, one essentially has the follow-

Call it a Goldmine
(Opinion on the market potential in education sector)

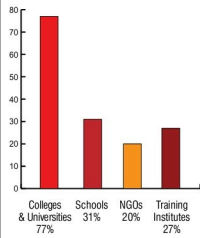


ing in mind: colleges that offer degree programmes and further higher education opportunities; training organisations that offer short-term courses and diploma programmes; NGOs that work on betterment of education; and schools that offer secondary education. The electronics industry has collaborations with each of these types of institutes with the chunk of its focus being on colleges and universities—claimed by around 77 per cent respondents. Schools came next with about 31 per cent respondents identifying them as an area of interest.

Electronics goods that are most in demand in the education sector are various types of lab equipment, with around 72 per cent re-

Target Customers

(Preference on target customer segment within education sector)



spondents having experienced it in their interaction with the educational institutes. Not surprising, given that practical, experimental knowledge is the key to success in the electronics world. Around 66 per cent respondents felt IT infrastructure and security related equipment were also a key requirement of the sector. With the need for high-end security measures increasing by the day, it is only obvious that this would indeed be an area of high demand. To support latest security technology and other business processes, an up-to-date IT infrastructure is a must.

One thing to bear in mind for the industry, though, is the fact that the education sector is cost-conscious. That is, cost is a differentiator here. Apart from cost, service and quality are the key aspects to focus on. Product

